Hirfa - Connecting Skills to Opportunity

Find a trusted local expert in 60 seconds in Kakuma.

By Adam | Power Learn Project

Local Skills, Global Trust

Problem

- In Kakuma, 70% of skilled workers are jobless because they are invisible.
- Customers waste days searching for a plumber, tailor, or developer.
- No trust, no reviews, no central place.

Solution

- Hirfa App: Customer posts job with photo
- App finds 3 nearest verified artisans
- Customer picks & chats
- With ratings, M-Pesa, and chat.

Market Size

- Kakuma + Kalobeyei: 300K people. Turkana: 1M+. Kenya informal sector: $20B. Target: 10K fundis x 50K households.

Product

- 1. Artisan profile 2. Post job 3. Smart matching by skill/location 4. Chat + M-Pesa 5. Reviews. Works on low-end phones.

Business Model

- 10% commission per job. KES 50 premium boost. Future: NGO subscription $500/month. CAC $1 via WhatsApp.

Traction

- Interviewed 15 fundis in Kakuma 3, 12 agreed to pay 10%. Wireframe ready. Founder lives in Kakuma. Next: MVP in 4 weeks.

Competition

- : Facebook Groups: unorganized, no trust. Word of mouth: slow. BrighterMonday: formal jobs only. Hirfa: hyper-local, verified.

Go-to-Market

- Phase 1: Community leaders, WhatsApp groups. Phase 2: Posters in market. Phase 3: Partner with UNHCR & NGOs.

Team

- Founder: Adam - Developer from Kakuma, PLP Student. Understands problem. Skills: Python, Community. Advisor: PLP Mentor.

Financials

- Year 1: 500 fundis, 2000 jobs, KES 400K. Year 2: 2000 fundis, expand to Lodwar. Break-even at 300 jobs/month

The Ask

- Asking $500 seed to build MVP and pilot with 50 fundis. Goal: 1000 users in 3 months. Thank you! Asante! Shukran!